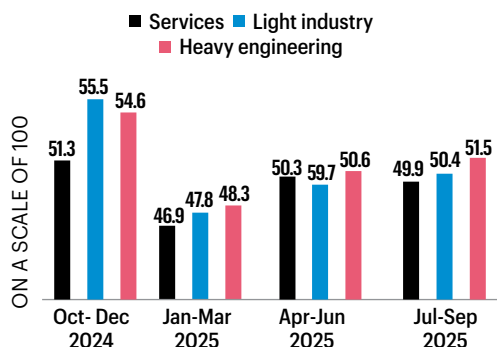
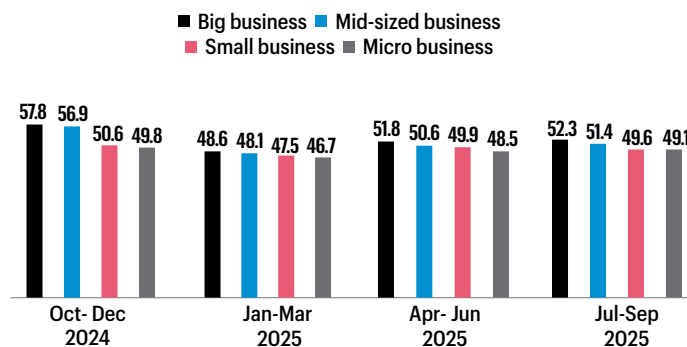


CONFIDENCE DIPS IN SERVICES SECTOR

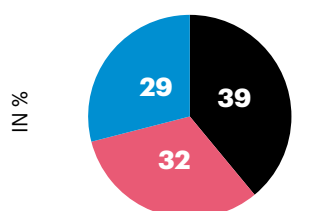


SMALL, MICRO INDUSTRIES IN PAIN



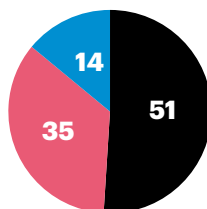
SIGNS OF TURBULENCE

Half way into the fiscal, are you confident of domestic growth prospects?



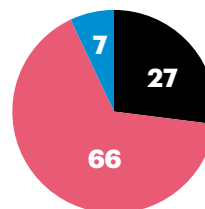
■ Yes, expect growth to do better due to better domestic demand
■ No, growth may be slower due to weaker exports
■ Can't Say

What is your top concern this quarter?



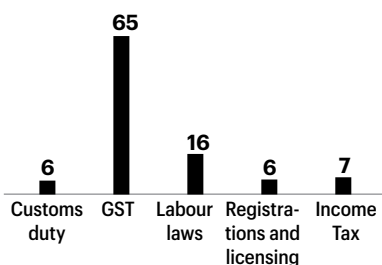
■ Continued US tariffs
■ Low consumer demand
■ Slower growth

Have the GST rate cuts helped boost your sales?

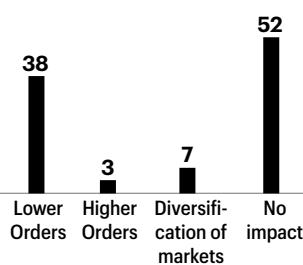


■ Yes ■ No ■ Can't Say

What is the most difficult compliance for your business?



What has been the impact of the higher US tariffs on your business?



What is the most important impact of AI on jobs in your company?



Source The BT-C Fore Business Confidence Survey conducted between October 7 and 25, 2025, of 500 CEOs or CFOs representing various industries and company sizes across 12 cities—Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru, Kolkata, Chandigarh, Lucknow, Nagpur, Kochi, Visakhapatnam and Bhubaneswar

tively, small and micro industries were less optimistic with business confidence at 49.6 and 49.1, respectively.

Experts say the data is not surprising given the turbulence during the year. While domestic policy has been supportive of growth and consumption, the weaker global environment, particularly due to hefty US tariffs and absence of a trade deal, have sparked newer worries

for businesses that were already unsure about demand prospects.

“Given the different themes playing out, there is no singular picture or number for the entire industry in terms of business confidence,” says Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda. Heavy and infrastructure industries continue to do well given the focus of the